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Jnana Sangama, Belagavi - 590 018, Karnataka



NutriSense: AI-Based Food Portion Estimation and Nutritional Compliance Monitoring System

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PROJECT WORK – 2

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MACHINE LEARNING

(UG Program: B.E. in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning)

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that Aryan Kumar bearing USN: 1BM23AI037, Roshanth V bearing USN: 1BM23AI155, S S Gokula Swamy bearing USN: 1BM23AI158, and Somanath S D bearing USN: 1BM23AI187 have satisfactorily completed the Course – Project Work – 2 (Course Code: 24AM7PWPW2) with the title "NutriSense: AI-Based Food Portion Estimation and Nutritional Compliance Monitoring System" in partial fulfillment of the academic curriculum requirements of the VII Semester UG Program – B.E. in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning in the Department of Machine Learning, BMSCE, an Autonomous Institute, affiliated to Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi during November 2026. The base work considered for the presentation is used for academic purposes and has not been used in its original form elsewhere for the award of any degree.

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DECLARATION

We hereby declare that the project entitled “NutriSense: AI-Based Food Portion Estimation and Nutritional Compliance Monitoring System” is a project work carried out by us as part of Project Work - 2 (24AM7PWPW2) in the Department of Machine Learning, B.M.S. College of Engineering, Bengaluru, during the academic year 2026-2027, under the guidance of Prof. Varsha R.

We further declare that the technical descriptions and results presented in this report are based on the project repository and the development/evaluation records available at the time of report preparation. All external models, datasets, libraries, standards and publications used have been acknowledged in the references. Results are reported with their documented limitations; no unverified outcome is represented as a validated system capability.

Place: Bengaluru
Date: 31-10-2026

Signatures

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We acknowledge the contributions of the open-source research and engineering communities whose work forms the foundation of the computer-vision and machine-learning components used in this project. In particular, the project builds upon research and software associated with Segment Anything Model 2.1, SigLIP 2, MoGe-2, DINOv2, PyTorch, OpenCV, Transformers, FastAPI and React. We also acknowledge the public nutrition and programme documents and food-composition references cited in the project data and documentation.

Finally, we thank all individuals who provided technical discussions, project feedback and assistance during research, implementation, data collection planning, testing and documentation.

ABSTRACT

NutriSense is an AI-based meal-analysis prototype that estimates the edible portion mass of food from an image and assesses selected energy and protein requirements for configured school-meal categories. It addresses a monitoring gap: a record that a meal was served does not establish the nutritional value of the portion on an individual plate. The system therefore explores a vision-based workflow that produces an auditable estimate while exposing image-quality and evidence limitations.

The implementation combines a Python FastAPI backend with a React and TypeScript frontend. Its analysis pipeline validates the image and context, detects a known-size ArUco marker where available, segments food using SAM 2.1, matches dish crops against a SigLIP 2 gallery, estimates depth with MoGe-2, and derives portion mass through geometric or eligible learned estimation paths. Monte Carlo sampling propagates portion and composition uncertainty into energy and protein estimates. A structured response records verdicts, reasons, failures, assumptions, coverage and model/policy provenance.

On the documented WED evaluation setup, the deployable mass-estimation head reports
15.034 g development MAE and 14.667 g locked-evaluation MAE. These are portion-mass results, not measures of calorie or protein accuracy. The recorded nominal 90% prediction intervals under-cover, and the project readiness notes unresolved multi-item, nutrition-transfer, calibration and production-validation work. NutriSense is therefore a research prototype and decision-support workflow, not a certified weighing device or autonomous compliance authority.

Keywords: Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Computer Vision, Food Image Analysis, SAM 2.1, SigLIP 2, Monocular Depth Estimation, Portion Mass Estimation, Monte Carlo Uncertainty, PM POSHAN.

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview

Food and nutrition programmes are intended not only to make meals available but also to provide meals that meet defined nutritional requirements. In school settings, meal quality is relevant to children's health, well-being and ability to participate in education. Operational monitoring commonly involves menu records, ingredient allocations, preparation records and physical inspection. These sources are useful, but they do not always quantify the actual cooked portion served on an individual plate.

NutriSense investigates whether computer vision and machine learning can assist this monitoring process. A user captures an image of a served meal, supplies basic context such as the menu day and student class band, and submits the image for analysis. The system attempts to identify the supported dish, isolate the food region, infer its scale and portion mass, estimate energy and protein from component-level composition data, and compare probability distributions of the estimated nutrients with configured minimum requirements.

The project is a decision-support prototype. Image-based estimation is inherently uncertain because a two-dimensional image does not directly reveal food depth, density, hidden ingredients, serving history or recipe composition. NutriSense therefore includes an evidence-quality and coverage mechanism. It is designed to communicate when scale is measured, when a value is estimated from a prior, when inputs are out of scope, and when the evidence is not adequate for a confident result.

At the software level, NutriSense is implemented as a Python FastAPI backend and a React 18/TypeScript frontend. The backend coordinates model inference, policy checks, data access and a typed analysis response. The model components include SAM 2.1 for segmentation, SigLIP 2 for gallery-based dish recognition, MoGe-2 for monocular depth, and a DINOv2-based learned weight-estimation path trained on WED data. Nutrient calculations and compliance rules are implemented as explicit computational stages rather than being delegated to a single opaque classifier.

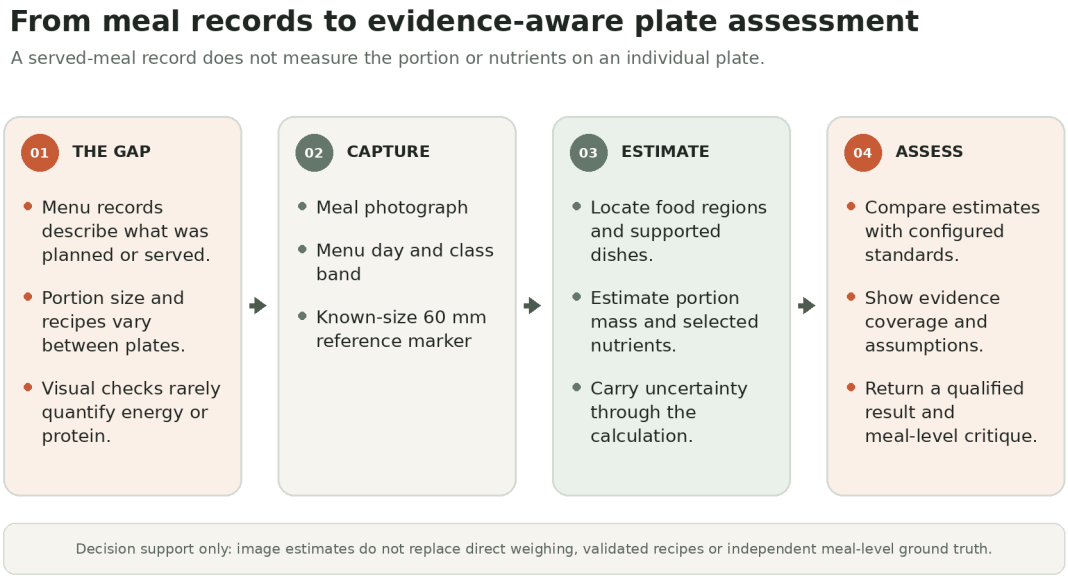


Figure 1.1: NutriSense problem context and output workflow

1.2 Scope

The scope of NutriSense is limited to image-based estimation and nutritional adequacy assessment for supported meal categories and configured class bands. The codebase contains a menu configuration and policy standards for selected school meal cases, along with broader experimental/off-menu model mappings. The API requires a day and class band and optionally accepts a serving style. The system uses the menu configuration as the source of truth for supported dish names and day availability.

Included within scope	**Outside the validated scope / constraints**
Browser image upload and FastAPI analysis API	Clinical diagnosis, individual medical advice or disease prediction
Food-region segmentation, dish classification and geometric or learned portion-mass estimation	Certified weighing-device functionality or guaranteed exact mass from one image
Energy and protein estimates using configured composition values	Validated full macronutrient panel; fat/carbohydrate estimates are unsupported by the current local table
PM POSHAN-style threshold assessment for configured class bands	Government audit, beneficiary identity verification or final administrative compliance decision
Explicit uncertainty, evidence coverage, assumptions and abstention	Calibrated 90% intervals; current calibration does not meet documented coverage/width criteria

Included within scope	Outside the validated scope / constraints
Research evaluation and local prototype	Production-scale deployment; sustained concurrency and operational budgets are unestablished

Table 1.1: Project scope and boundaries

The project is also bounded by its capture protocol. The measured-scale route is designed around a printed 60.0 mm ArUco marker placed beside the vessel on the same plane. Digital zoom must be disabled, the original image metadata should be preserved, the marker must be visible at adequate pixel size, and the tray must be fully inside the frame. These controls improve repeatability but require cooperation from the person collecting the image.

1.3 Existing System

Conventional meal monitoring can use paper-based menu registers, ingredient allocation schedules, kitchen-level production records, manual weighing, visual inspection and periodic nutrition surveys. Each method captures a different aspect of programme operation. Ingredient allocation can express intended quantities, whereas weighing can provide direct mass measurements. Manual calculations can estimate nutrient values when the recipe and composition information are known.

However, these methods have practical limitations. Manual weighing each served portion can be time-consuming. Visual inspection alone cannot reliably infer mass or nutrient content. A menu entry does not establish the composition of a particular cooked plate. Recipe variation, water absorption, cooking yield, oil quantity and serving density can affect the relationship between raw ingredient allocations and cooked plate mass. A monitoring system should also communicate uncertainty rather than translating every incomplete observation into a binary decision.

Dimension	Conventional/manual approach	NutriSense approach
Observation	Menu records, visual inspection or direct weighing	Photograph-based capture with contextual inputs
Portion mass	Scale measurement or visual judgement	Geometric estimate with reference marker, or learned WED mass head for eligible no-card cases

Dimension	Conventional/manual approach	NutriSense approach
Nutrient calculation	Manual lookup and arithmetic	Component mass combined with configured per-100 g values and uncertainty sampling
Decision	Human interpretation of records and measurements	Probability and evidence-coverage policy; definitive results require configured gates
Food identity	Known from menu or observer	Gallery-based visual embeddings; unsupported cases can abstain
Traceability	Depends on record-keeping practice	Structured reasons, assumptions, model versions, policy digest and provenance

Table 1.2: Comparison of conventional and proposed approaches

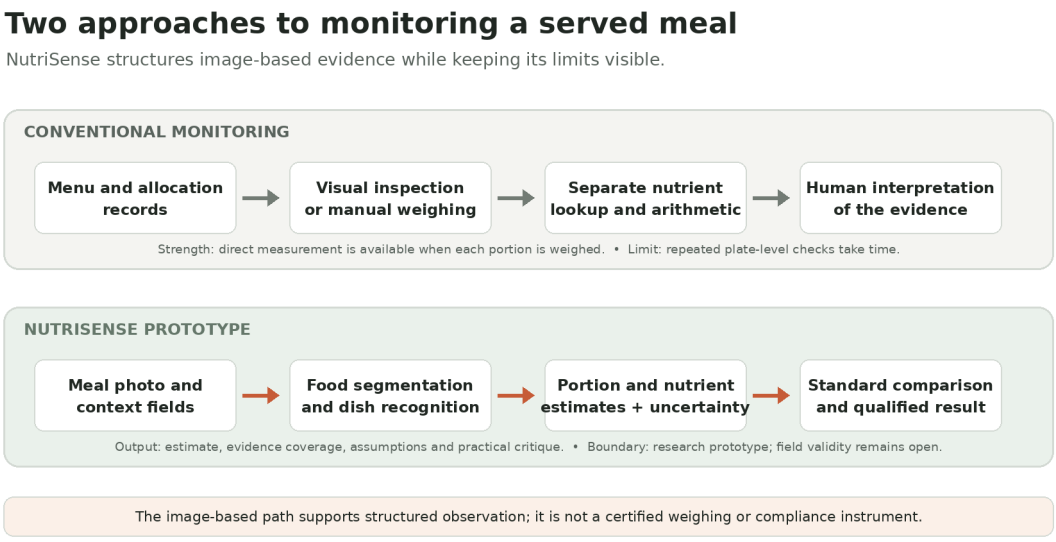


Figure 1.2: Existing and proposed system comparison

1.4 Proposed System

NutriSense proposes an integrated image-analysis workflow that combines multiple specialised models and deterministic policy logic. The system begins with an image and context fields, performs capture linting, and then follows a sequence of model and computational stages. A physical reference card supplies a known dimension for image scale. Food segmentation isolates a candidate food region. Dish classification maps the

appearance to a supported dish label. Monocular depth and camera geometry are used to estimate food

geometry, while dish configuration supplies component identities, nominal shares and density values. Where the reference card is absent, the implementation may use a trained weight head for a mapped dish when a compatible checkpoint is available; geometry priors are not silently substituted for that learned path when the head is required but unavailable.

After estimating portion mass, NutriSense propagates uncertainty through Monte Carlo sampling. The nutrient engine samples uncertainties in mass and composition, computes energy and protein samples, and summarises their distributions. The compliance module

computes the probability that each mandatory nutrient reaches its configured minimum. A result is then determined using both nutrient probability and evidence coverage. A structured reason is attached when evidence is estimated, degraded or insufficient.

The proposed system therefore differs from a basic image classifier. It aims to make each stage inspectable and to prevent a visually plausible result from being presented without its evidence quality. Its current limitations, including incomplete validation of nutrition transfer and multi-item analysis, are documented in Chapter 7.

CHAPTER 2

PROBLEM STATEMENT

2.1 Problem Statement

There is a need for a repeatable, low-friction method to estimate the portion mass and selected nutritional properties of prepared meals using accessible image capture, while making the reliability of the estimate explicit. In a school-meal monitoring context, the key challenge is not simply recognising the dish. A useful assessment requires the system to estimate how much food is present, relate the mass to an appropriate composition model, account for uncertainty and compare the resulting nutrient distribution with a policy threshold.

The technical problem can be expressed as follows: given an RGB image I, menu-day context d, student class band b and optional serving-style metadata s, estimate a food/dish representation, portion mass M and nutrient vector N = (E, P), where E denotes energy in kilocalories and P denotes protein in grams. Then estimate the probabilities P(E >= E_min(b)) and P(P >= P_min(b)) and produce a policy result only when the capture and evidence coverage conditions are met. The system must also identify inputs for which this calculation is not defensible and abstain or return cannot_verify/out_of_scope rather than inventing a value.

The problem is challenging because image pixels are not direct measurements of grams. Perspective, camera calibration, occlusion, bowl geometry, food texture, depth estimation, density assumptions, recipe composition and image quality all affect the result. For this reason, the project treats portion mass, nutrient composition and compliance as separate but linked estimation and decision stages.

2.2 Motivation

The motivation is to support evidence-based observation of meal adequacy. In many food-programme settings, records may establish which menu item was planned or served, but assessing the nutritional content of an individual plate requires additional measurement. A computer-vision workflow may help reduce repetitive manual calculation and enable structured data collection, especially where basic image-capture devices are available.

A second motivation is the need for transparent uncertainty. An automated system should not

imply that a single photograph provides a laboratory measurement. NutriSense therefore uses a reference marker, data-quality linting, uncertainty propagation, explicit prior tiers and policy coverage thresholds. It also records assumptions such as estimated recipe shares and nutrient-table rows.

The project is aligned with the practical use of machine learning for a public-interest problem. It combines model development with data provenance, evaluation discipline, interpretable output and ethical image-capture rules. It also creates a foundation for future studies using independently weighed meals and better-calibrated composition data.

2.3 Objectives

- Develop a web-based system for uploading a meal photograph and supplying the required contextual metadata.
- Implement capture-quality checks, including image resolution, digital zoom, marker visibility and valid menu-day/class-band inputs.
- Use computer-vision models to segment food regions and recognise supported dishes.
- Estimate physical scale and food geometry from a known-size ArUco marker, camera information and monocular depth, with clearly identified prior/learned alternatives when measured scale is unavailable.
- Estimate portion mass and, where configured, decompose meals into component-level mass contributions.
- Estimate energy and protein using a traceable food-composition table and propagate input uncertainty through Monte Carlo sampling.
- Assess nutritional adequacy using probability and evidence-coverage thresholds defined in the project policy configuration.
- Return a structured and auditable analysis with reasons, failures, assumptions, model versions, policy information and degradations.
- Evaluate the system using unit, integration, frontend and model evaluation procedures, and document current limitations honestly.

CHAPTER 3

LITERATURE SURVEY

NutriSense integrates ideas from image segmentation, vision-language representation learning, monocular depth estimation, fiducial marker geometry, learned mass regression and probabilistic decision systems. The literature and model references below are selected because they correspond directly to components identified in the repository. The purpose of this chapter is to explain the relevance of these methods to the project architecture, not to claim that any individual paper validates the complete NutriSense application.

3.1 Analysis of Gaps, Project Progress and Completed Activities

3.1.1 Image Segmentation

The Segment Anything Model 2 (SAM 2) family provides promptable segmentation for images and videos. NutriSense uses the SAM 2.1 Hiera-Large model through the Transformers interface. Its implementation queries the image centre using a point prompt and evaluates multiple candidate masks. Candidate selection incorporates solidity, area constraints and containment relationships rather than selecting solely by the model's raw predicted IoU score. If the centre-point result is absent, too small or too large, the implementation makes a centre-box prompted retry. This is important because a segmentation mask that captures only a rim arc or a small patch of food would distort all downstream geometric estimates. [1].

The current implementation also includes a multi-vessel route. It samples a 3-by-3 grid of prompts inside a coarse box, selects candidate masks, removes near-duplicates using intersection-over-union (IoU), filters by area and limits the number of detected vessels to four. The available development records note that this route remains a research area: on real canteen photographs, the item-mask areas can spill into surrounding context and the same food component may be assigned to multiple vessels in some diagnostic frames.

3.1.2 Dish Recognition and Vision-Language Embeddings

SigLIP 2 is a vision-language encoder designed to produce semantically useful visual representations. NutriSense uses a SigLIP 2 base patch-16 224 checkpoint to embed a food crop and compare it with a gallery of reference dish images. The selected class is therefore

gallery-based rather than a conventional closed-set classifier trained only within this repository. This approach allows the system to manage its dish vocabulary through reference images and mappings. However, the performance depends on gallery coverage, visual similarity, image capture conditions and the chosen abstention threshold. Recognition accuracy on a controlled gallery must not automatically be interpreted as robustness to arbitrary canteen photographs. [2].

3.1.3 Monocular Depth and Scale Recovery

Monocular depth estimation attempts to infer scene depth from a single RGB image. NutriSense integrates MoGe-2 for dense depth and geometry cues. A monocular model alone does not guarantee a reliable physical metric scale. The project therefore uses the known physical size of a fiducial marker to establish scale and calibrate the model's depth output. The marker is detected using OpenCV ArUco functions, with pose estimation based on camera intrinsics derived preferentially from EXIF 35 mm-equivalent focal length, then EXIF focal length and an assumed sensor width, or a fallback focal length. [3], [5].

The marker establishes a measured anchor only if the configured marker identity is detected, its size is sufficient, and its quiet-zone check passes. If the marker cannot be used, the anchor stage falls back to a prior tier. The implementation deliberately does not use plate diameter as a scale fallback. This design makes the source of metric scale explicit and avoids treating an unknown plate size as a physical calibration object.

3.1.4 Learned Portion-Mass Estimation

The repository includes a DINOv2-feature-based learned weight head trained and evaluated using the WED dataset. It predicts mass for mapped food classes and provides an alternative for eligible no-reference-card cases. This route is distinct from geometric estimation: it relies on learned appearance-to-mass relationships rather than a physically measured scale. The backend loads the head lazily when the checkpoint exists and uses it for mapped dishes under the configured conditions. A missing or failed checkpoint is not treated as proof of a valid learned estimate. Where the required head is unavailable, the pipeline produces a structured failure for that path rather than silently switching to a misleading geometry measurement. [4].

3.1.5 Probabilistic Nutrient Estimation and Decision Rules

Food composition tables provide nutrient density values, usually expressed per 100 g edible portion. For an estimated component mass m_i and table density q_i, the point contribution is proportional to m_i q_i / 100. In NutriSense, these inputs are not treated as exact. The Monte Carlo engine samples uncertainty in the portion and nutrient-table values, calculates energy and protein samples and then aggregates samples across detected meal components. The compliance engine evaluates the probability that a mandatory nutrient meets its minimum, with additional coverage requirements to prevent low-quality estimates from receiving definitive labels. [6], [7].

3.1.6 Gaps Identified and Current Project Progress

Technical gap	**NutriSense response**	**Current evidence and limitation**
A photograph has no inherent physical scale	60 mm ArUco marker and camera geometry	Measured tier implemented; prior tier remains uncertain
Mask may include plate, rim or table	SAM 2.1 candidate filtering, containment and box-prompt retry	Synthetic cases covered; broad real-photo segmentation validation remains open
Dish identity alone does not determine mass	Geometry route and WED-trained mass head	WED regression results are available; mixed-meal transfer remains limited
Nutrient values depend on recipe and composition	Configured component shares and per-100 g nutrient table	Some menu values are assumed; recipe-specific ground truth is needed
Point estimates hide uncertainty	Monte Carlo distributions, intervals and evidence coverage	Observed nominal 90% interval coverage is below 90%
Binary outputs can overstate weak evidence	Input/scope gates and structured estimate/abstention outcomes	Policy logic is implemented; field validity is not established
Manual monitoring is difficult to scale	Browser application, API and reusable policy/configuration endpoints	Local prototype; production capacity and sustained-load budgets are open

Table 3.1: Technical gaps and NutriSense response

3.1.7 Completed Activities Recorded in the Repository

- Modular backend stages and a structured analysis contract have been implemented.

- Core model integrations for SAM 2.1, SigLIP 2 and MoGe-2 are present in the inference pipeline.
- ArUco marker detection, EXIF parsing, camera pose estimation and a measured/prior anchor distinction are implemented.
- A WED-trained learned mass-estimation head and class mappings are included in the current repository.
- Monte Carlo nutrient sampling, multi-item aggregation and policy-based compliance assessment are implemented.
- A React/TypeScript frontend and Zod response-schema contract are included.
- Capture protocols, data manifests, evaluation reports, model-readiness documentation and automated tests have been added.
- The readiness record reports 70 passing frontend tests and a successful production frontend build in the recorded environment; current backend verification is qualified because the full run did not complete in the restricted 2026-10-30 environment.

3.2 Justification of the Selected Problem

The selected problem is appropriate for an AI and Machine Learning major project because it requires the integration of several distinct AI capabilities with domain-specific rules. Food segmentation is a dense visual prediction task; dish recognition is a semantic representation task; depth estimation and camera geometry are 3D inference tasks; portion estimation is a regression task; nutrient estimation is a propagation-of-uncertainty problem; and the final assessment is a constrained probabilistic decision problem. The end-to-end result cannot be solved reliably by a single classifier.

The problem also has a clear social application and measurable intermediate outputs. Physical mass can be compared with kitchen-scale ground truth, recognition can be evaluated against labelled images, segmentation can be evaluated using overlap/area metrics, nutrient calculations can be checked against recipe/composition references, and API behavior can be tested with contract and boundary cases. This allows the project to be evaluated as an engineering system rather than as a demonstration-only interface.

A key reason for selecting this problem is that it makes model limitations visible. A trustworthy tool should know when a reference marker is missing, when a dish is unsupported, when a model stage fails, when the food-composition value is assumed and

when uncertainty is too large for a definitive assessment. NutriSense explicitly encodes these cases into its response contract and policy logic.

3.3 Project Contribution to Society and Sustainable Development Goals

NutriSense is intended to support the monitoring of meal quality in school nutrition programmes. It does not replace programme administrators, nutrition experts or direct weighing. Its potential contribution is to make selected meal observations more structured and quantifiable, provided that its estimation accuracy and data-collection procedures are validated in representative field conditions.

Sustainable Development Goal	**Relevant target**	**Project contribution and boundary**
SDG 2: Zero Hunger	Target 2.2	Estimate selected meal energy/protein adequacy and expose cases needing further measurement; no health outcome is predicted.
SDG 3: Good Health and Well-being	Target 3.4	Improve visibility of meal adequacy as one input to broader monitoring; NutriSense does not provide diagnosis or treatment.
SDG 4: Quality Education	Target 4.1	Support structured observation of school-meal provision as a factor related to student well-being and participation.

Table 3.2: Project contribution to the Sustainable Development Goals

The project also supports responsible innovation by documenting uncertainty, data provenance and privacy constraints. The capture manual instructs users to photograph trays and food only and avoid children’s faces, uniforms, name tags or class boards. Student names

are not intended to be stored in the golden dataset metadata. Required permissions and consent practices at the collection site must be followed.

CHAPTER 4

SYSTEM REQUIREMENT SPECIFICATION

4.1 Functional Requirements

ID	Functional requirement	Priority
FR-01	Provide a browser interface for submitting a meal image.	High
FR-02	Accept menu day and student class band; serving style is optional.	High
FR-03	Validate upload size, image decoding, day, band and digital-zoom constraints.	High
FR-04	Detect a supported ArUco marker and establish measured scale when valid.	High
FR-05	Segment food regions and return structured failure/abstention when no usable mask is produced.	High
FR-06	Map a supported dish to a configured menu/gallery identity or report unsupported scope.	High
FR-07	Estimate portion mass using the applicable geometric or learned path.	High
FR-08	Estimate energy and protein from configured component mappings and nutrient rows.	High
FR-09	Propagate uncertainty and calculate evidence-coverage/probability values.	High
FR-10	Return PASS, FAIL, BORDERLINE, cannot_verify or out_of_scope when supported by evidence.	High
FR-11	Expose health, menu, goals and analysis endpoints.	Medium
FR-12	Include reasons, assumptions, model versions, policy metadata and degradation information.	High

Table 4.1: Functional requirements

4.2 Non-functional Requirements

Quality attribute	Requirement
Reliability	Convert stage failures into structured failures or

Quality attribute	Requirement
	abstentions rather than unhandled server errors.
Performance	Use available GPU acceleration; serialize inference per backend process to control VRAM use.
Scalability	Support a controlled local prototype; validate multi-worker/multi-user scaling against a target deployment.
Usability	Guide capture and present estimates, reasons and policy notes in readable form.
Maintainability	Centralize menu, policy, nutrient and calibration configuration.
Interoperability	Use a JSON API and a generated TypeScript/Zod response contract.
Security	Configure CORS and upload limits; require authentication and TLS for non-local deployment.
Privacy	Collect food/tray images only; exclude identifiable student information from the dataset.
Auditability	Return model versions, policy digest, assumptions, reasons and degradations; retain evaluation provenance.
Robustness	Warn or abstain on invalid captures, weak evidence and unsupported inputs instead of fabricating measurements.

Table 4.2: Non-functional requirements

4.3 Hardware Requirements

The repository’s documented development setup recommends an NVIDIA GPU with CUDA for practical model inference, while allowing CPU execution at lower speed. The readiness record identifies an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4060 Laptop GPU with 8 GB VRAM as the measured local benchmark target. It also records that this is a development machine rather than an agreed production deployment platform.

Component	Development requirement / evidence
Processor	Modern 64-bit CPU for Python, Node.js and image-processing tasks; multi-core is useful for concurrent services/builds.
Memory	16 GB RAM is a practical development target; an exact minimum is not specified.
GPU	CUDA-capable NVIDIA GPU recommended for practical inference; local benchmark machine is RTX 4060 Laptop GPU with 8 GB VRAM. CPU execution is slower.
Storage	Several gigabytes for model weights, data and caches; README estimates approximately 3 GB of first-run model downloads.
Camera	Original JPEG with EXIF when available, main 1× lens, no digital zoom, stable capture and minimum-side target of 1280 px.

Table 4.3: Hardware requirements and evidence

4.4 Software Requirements

The software environment uses the Python backend and model-inference libraries, a Node.js-based frontend toolchain, structured YAML/JSON/NPZ configuration and data files,

and automated testing and quality tools. The implemented stack is summarised in Table 6.1. Exact dependency versions should be taken from the project manifests at the final submission commit.

- Backend runtime: Python 3.14, uv — Python runtime and reproducible dependency management.
- API: FastAPI, Uvicorn, AnyIO — HTTP API, asynchronous request handling and bounded threadpool inference.
- Computer vision: OpenCV, Pillow, NumPy — Image decoding, colour conversion, ArUco detection, mask operations and numerical processing.
- Deep learning: PyTorch, TorchVision, Transformers — Model execution and pretrained model integration.
- AI models: SAM 2.1 Hiera-Large, SigLIP 2 Base, MoGe-2, DINOv2-based weight head

  — Food segmentation, dish embeddings, monocular geometry/depth and learned mass

regression.

- Data/configuration: PyYAML, JSON, NPZ, YAML configuration — Menu, standards, nutrient data, anchor configuration and gallery storage.
- Frontend: Node 20+, React 18, TypeScript, Vite — Interactive browser interface and build pipeline.
- Frontend validation: Zod, Vitest, Testing Library — Runtime contract validation and UI tests.
- Testing/quality: Pytest, Ruff, Pyright — Backend testing, linting and type-check baseline gate.

CHAPTER 5

SYSTEM DESIGN

5.1 System Architecture

NutriSense follows a layered client-server architecture. The browser frontend collects the image and contextual inputs, provides the user-facing workflow and renders the analysis contract. The FastAPI backend handles upload validation, route execution and inference orchestration. The engine layer coordinates model stages and decision logic. The model layer contains reusable model adapters and registries. Configuration and data files provide menu definitions, policy standards, food composition values, model mappings and evaluation parameters.

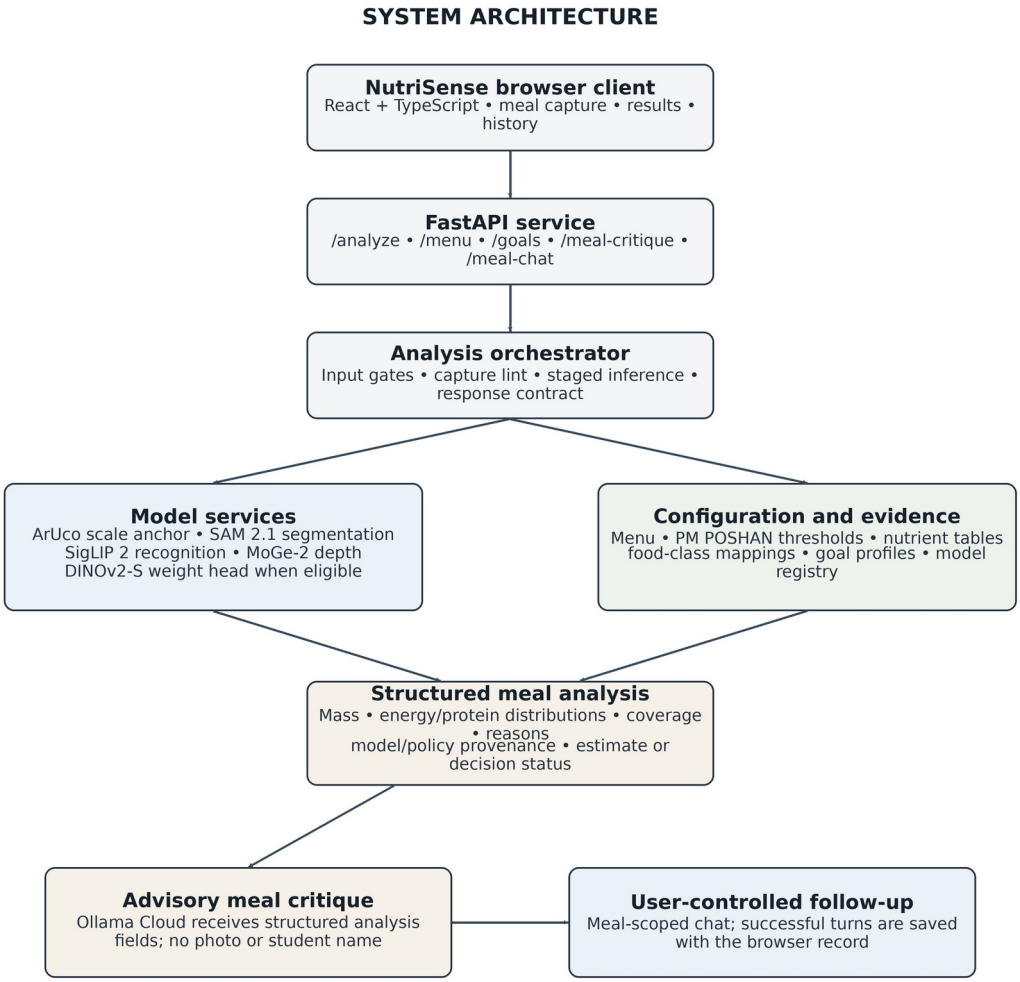


Figure 5.1: High-level system architecture

The backend loads expensive model assets lazily through a registry so that models need not be initialised at module import. A bounded AnyIO capacity limiter serialises inference to one request at a time per process, reducing GPU memory contention. The health and configuration endpoints remain asynchronous/lightweight and are not placed behind the same

inference limiter. A CUDA out-of-memory guard clears the model registry and retries a model stage once; a second failure is converted into a structured failure.

5.2 Methodology

The methodology is organised as a sequence of auditable stages. The pipeline's documented order is lint, anchor, segmentation, classification, depth, portion estimation, Monte Carlo sampling and verdict evaluation. Input gates and scope gates are applied at defined points. A fatal stage failure is returned as a structured failure; the anchor stage can degrade to a prior tier and continue with reduced evidence coverage.

Pipeline stage	**Main operation**	**Output / control**
Input validation	Check upload size, image decoding, EXIF, day, class band and digital zoom.	Valid image/context or structured rejection.
Capture lint and scale anchor	Check resolution and marker adequacy; detect the known-size ArUco marker.	Measured scale when valid; otherwise an explicitly labelled prior tier.
Food segmentation	Generate food masks with SAM 2.1; filter candidates and support multi-vessel processing.	Food masks and segmentation diagnostics.
Dish recognition and scope	Compare food crops with the SigLIP 2 gallery and resolve configured serving identities.	Supported dish identity, tentative estimate or scope abstention.
Depth and portion estimation	Use MoGe-2 geometry with measured-scale calibration; use eligible WED weight head when configured.	Estimated portion mass, method and uncertainty.
Nutrient estimation	Combine component mass with configured composition and Monte Carlo sampling.	Energy/protein distributions and intervals.
Policy assessment	Evaluate nutrient probabilities with evidence coverage in School mode; use goals in General mode.	School status or General goal context; weak evidence remains estimate-only.
Response and cleanup	Serialize the analysis contract and remove temporary upload data.	Auditable result with reasons, assumptions and provenance.

Table 5.1: Main analysis pipeline stages and responsibilities

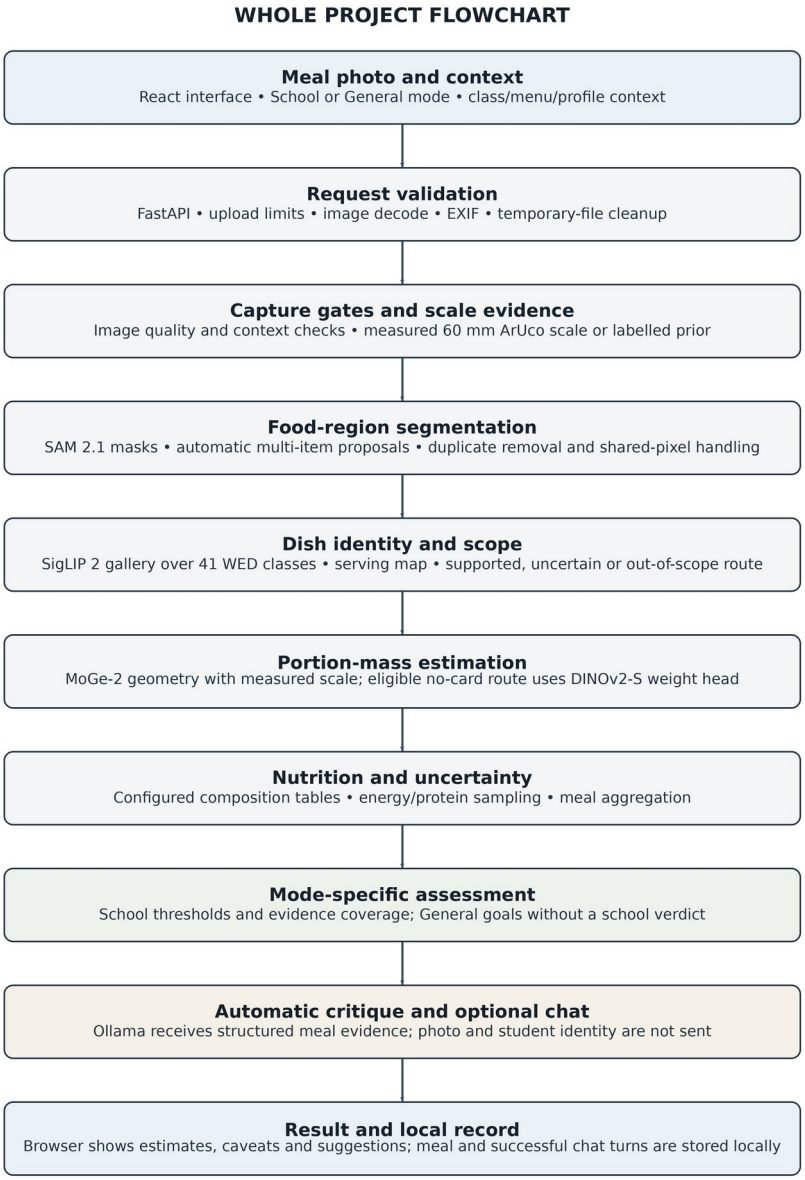


Figure 5.2: Whole-project flowchart from meal capture to saved meal critique

5.2.1 Image Capture and Input Validation

The analysis endpoint accepts a multipart image, menu day, student class band and optional serving style. The request body is written to a temporary file in 1 MiB chunks. The default maximum upload is 12 MiB, configurable using NUTRISENSE_MAX_UPLOAD_BYTES. The endpoint decodes the image using OpenCV, reads EXIF information, and passes the decoded BGR image and metadata to the pipeline. The temporary file is deleted in a finally block and the upload stream is closed regardless of success or failure.

The pipeline applies gates for digital zoom, supported day and valid class band. Digital zoom other than 1.0 is rejected because digital zoom breaks the assumed image geometry/capture

protocol. The menu file is the single source of truth for available dishes and days. The class-band vocabulary is restricted to 1-5, 6-8 and 9-10.

5.2.2 Metric Scale Anchor Using ArUco

The reference marker is a 60.0 mm ArUco marker (DICT_4X4_50, marker ID 7) printed at 100% scale. The system detects marker corners and estimates average side length in pixels. The image scale is calculated as: [5].

cm_per_pixel = marker_size_cm / marker_side_pixels

The physical marker dimension is 6.0 cm. Camera intrinsics are estimated using EXIF focal length, with a preference for 35 mm-equivalent focal length. Marker pose is recovered using camera geometry; a reprojection error above the configured tolerance rejects the pose while retaining the two-dimensional scale if valid. The implementation includes a quiet-zone test to reject false detections around dark borders. If a usable marker is absent or too small, the anchor label becomes prior and the result must carry a statement that the scale/weight is estimated.

5.2.3 Food Segmentation

SAM 2.1 is queried with a central positive point prompt. It returns multiple mask candidates. NutriSense computes mask area fraction and solidity and checks whether candidate masks are nested. This is motivated by the common relationship in food photographs where the food mask is contained inside a larger plate or scene mask. A selected mask should correspond to the food rather than the entire plate. If the central point produces an unusable speck or an excessively broad mask, a box-prompted query is attempted. The segmentation module returns a binary mask and diagnostic metadata such as strategy, model score, candidate count and area fraction.

For multi-vessel images, nine image locations are queried within a coarse central box. The resulting masks are deduplicated by IoU, sorted by area and truncated at four items. The multi-item route is included in the implementation but requires more field validation, as described in the readiness status.

5.2.4 Dish Classification

The segmented/cropped food region is passed to the SigLIP 2 encoder. The system compares its embedding with a stored dish gallery. The chosen gallery identity is mapped to menu and serving definitions. A gallery build tool produces the stored gallery from class reference images. The available development records note a current gallery size of 46 images and an internal leave-one-out result of 46/46, with an abstention threshold of 0.82. That result characterises the gallery check and must not be interpreted as a measured real-world canteen recognition rate.

5.2.5 Depth Estimation and Portion Mass

MoGe-2 provides monocular depth/geometry. When a measured marker anchor is present, the predicted depth scale is calibrated against the known marker geometry. The calibrated depth and food mask support the estimation of surface footprint, food height and volume. The portion estimator uses dish-specific density and composition information to convert estimated volume to mass. A simplified physical relationship is:

estimated_mass_g = estimated_volume_ml x effective_density_g_per_ml

When the reference marker is unavailable, the project distinguishes between size-prior geometry and a learned weight-head path. The WED-trained mass head predicts mass from the image and segmentation mask using mapped class slots. Its result is tagged as learned_weight and its uncertainty is taken from class-specific validation residuals where available, otherwise a fallback relative sigma is used. The system does not claim that such a learned estimate is a measured scale. No-card cases are explicitly labelled as estimates.

5.2.6 Nutrient Composition and Monte Carlo Estimation

The menu configuration defines dish components, generic nutrient identifiers, nominal recipe shares and effective density values. The food composition table expresses energy and protein per 100 g edible portion. When a component has estimated mass m_i, energy density e_i and protein density p_i, point estimates are:

Energy_kcal = sum_i (m_i / 100) x e_i Protein_g = sum_i (m_i / 100) x p_i

The Monte Carlo stage represents uncertain quantities using repeated samples. In the current pipeline, 4,000 samples are used by default unless overridden. The sampler propagates portion mass and composition uncertainty to energy and protein distributions. For multi-item

meals, per-item sample arrays are summed elementwise so that aggregate meal intervals are computed from the combined sample distribution rather than by simply adding interval

endpoints. The output includes means and 90% intervals, but the readiness report explicitly states that observed interval coverage is below nominal 90%; these intervals must therefore not be described as fully calibrated confidence intervals.

5.2.7 Nutritional Adequacy Assessment

The project's central configured minimums are 450 kcal and 12 g protein for classes 1-5, and 700 kcal and 20 g protein for classes 6-8. The 9-10 band uses a 700 kcal/20 g mapping inherited from the upper-primary reference in the application. The standards file explicitly records that a separate statewide Karnataka class IX-X energy/protein minimum is not established by its cited sources. Accordingly, the 9-10 values should be described as the application's mapping, not as an independently published state norm.

Class band	Minimum energy	Minimum protein	Evidence note
1–5	450 kcal	12 g	Central PM POSHAN minimum encoded in standards.yaml.
6–8	700 kcal	20 g	Central PM POSHAN minimum encoded in standards.yaml.
9–10	700 kcal	20 g	Application mapping inherited from classes 6–8; not stated as a separate statewide minimum.

Table 5.2: Nutritional compliance thresholds encoded in NutriSense

For each mandatory nutrient, the engine calculates the fraction of Monte Carlo samples at or above the configured minimum. Let P_n denote that probability and C denote the evidence coverage score. NutriSense applies the following decision rules:

PASS: all mandatory nutrients have P_n >= 0.90 AND C >= 0.85 FAIL: at least one mandatory nutrient has P_n <= 0.10 AND C >= 0.90 BORDERLINE: all other admitted cases

Coverage is a multiplicative score derived from evidence degradation factors, including prior anchor, estimated weight, table-prior base, degraded quality and uncalibrated depth. The

prior geometry path is deliberately capped and cannot issue a definitive PASS/FAIL. The learned weight path is also marked estimated and receives an estimated-weight coverage factor. Salt is advisory only and is not a verdict nutrient. Raw ingredient allocations are diagnostic only; they must not be directly compared to cooked plate mass because cooking yield changes mass.

5.3 Detailed Design

5.3.1 Class Diagram

The implementation describes NutriSense as a service-oriented implementation rather than a single object-oriented class hierarchy. Figure 5.3(a) is therefore a conceptual class/module view: it maps the application entry point, configuration loader, pipeline stages and response records. It does not imply that every box is a Python class.

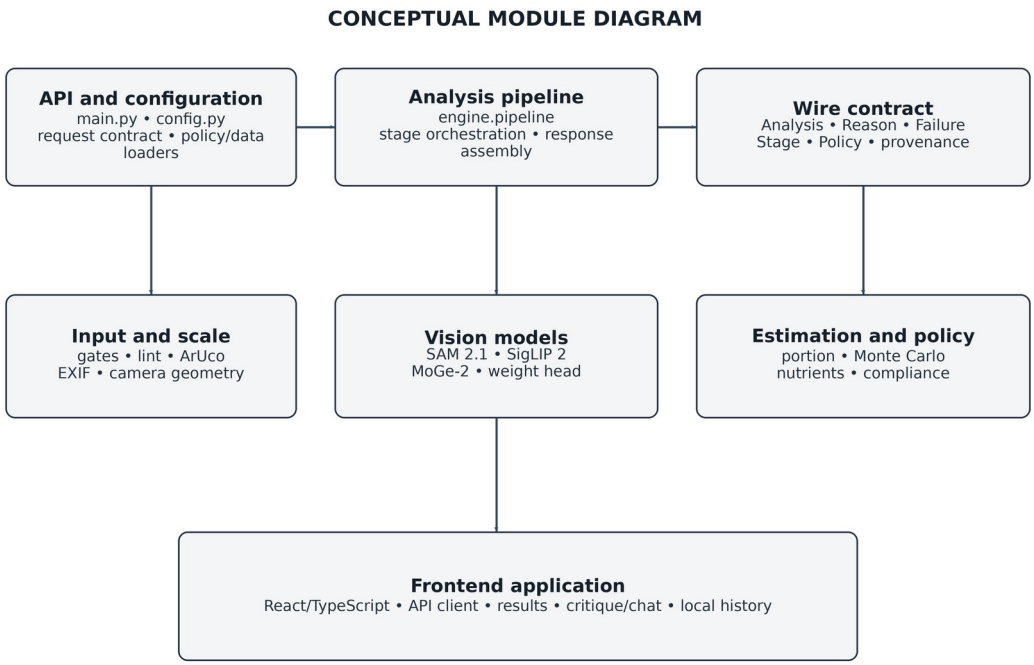


Figure 5.3(a): Conceptual class and module diagram

The main conceptual entities are Analysis, Reason, Failure, Stage, Policy and the model-stage outputs. Analysis holds the final verdict and component outputs. Reason communicates why a verdict or abstention occurred. Failure records a failed stage with its category and details. Stage identifies the processing stage associated with a failure. Policy captures the thresholds and policy-version digest used to evaluate the sample. This separation supports consistent error reporting and prevents frontend code from independently re-deriving policy decisions.

5.3.2 Activity Diagram

The activity diagram models the request path and its documented decision branches: file and context validation, measured-versus-prior anchor handling, supported-dish checks, structured abstention and response cleanup.

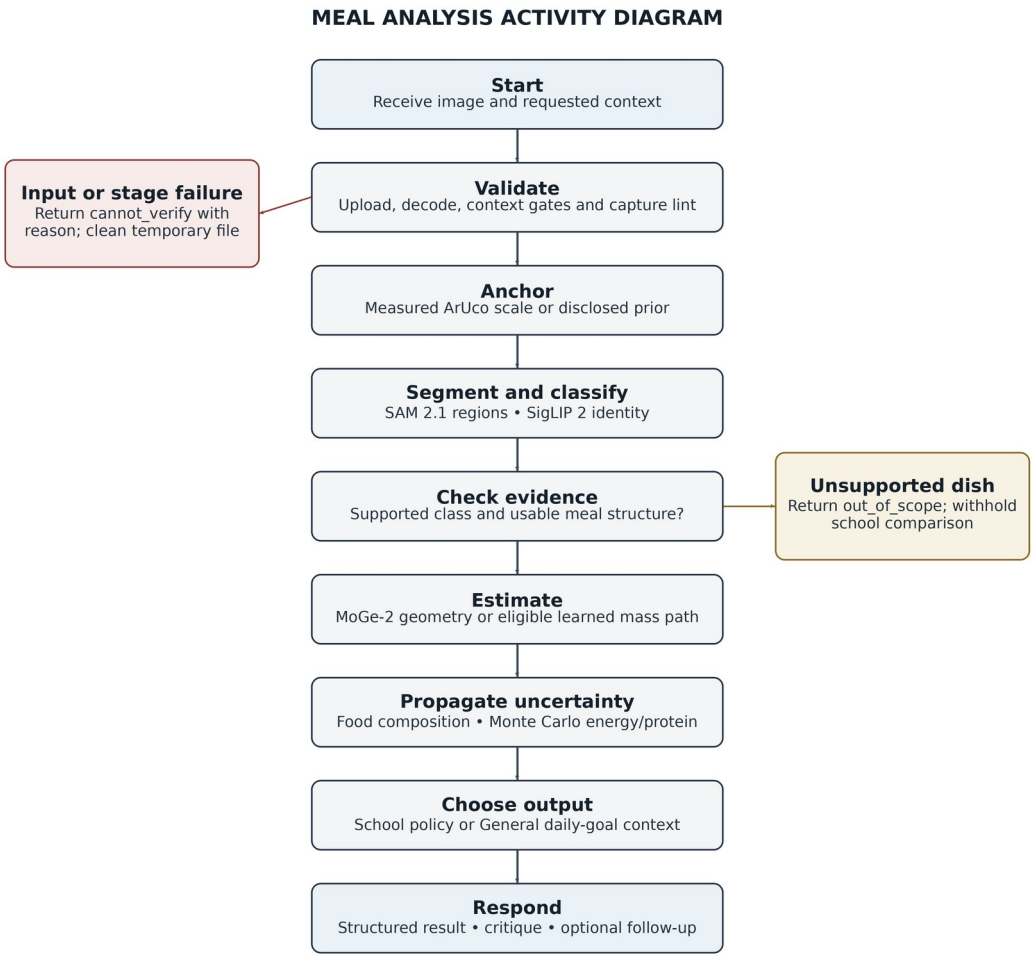


Figure 5.3(b): Activity diagram for meal analysis

5.3.3 Use Case Diagram

The meal-monitoring user is the primary application actor. The user selects the relevant context, submits a meal image and reviews the returned estimate and evidence. The administrator/developer shown is a configuration maintainer; the diagram does not assert the presence of a separate in-app administration console.

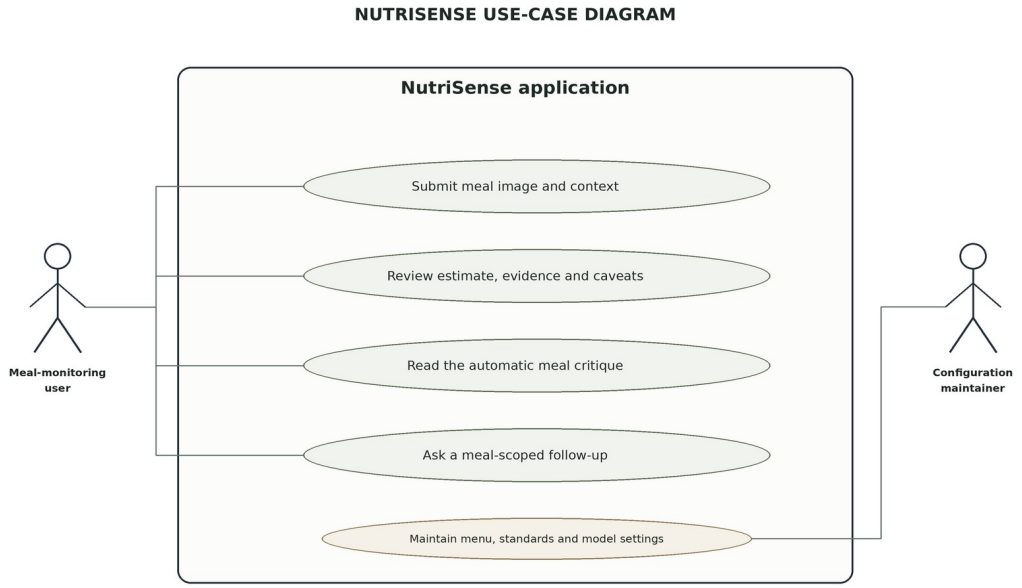


Figure 5.3(c): Use case diagram with separated application actors

Response field group	**Purpose**
verdict / compliance	Policy outcome and nutrient-level probability information.
reasons / failures	Gate rejections, abstentions and stage failures.
lint / anchor	Capture-quality checks and scale-anchor method.
segmentation / classification / dish	Food-mask and dish-identification outputs.
portion	Estimated mass, selected estimation path and uncertainty.
nutrition	Energy/protein estimates and sampled intervals.
coverage / assumptions	Evidence quality, prior use and modeling assumptions.
model_versions / policy	Model, policy and configuration provenance.
path_used / degradations / items	Processing route, reduced-evidence conditions and item-level outputs.

Table 5.3: Analysis response contract (selected fields)

CHAPTER 6

IMPLEMENTATION

6.1 Overview of Tools and Technologies Used

The project uses Python for model orchestration and TypeScript/React for the interactive browser client. FastAPI exposes health, menu, goals and analysis endpoints, together with meal-critique and meal-chat endpoints. The browser presents School and General modes, structured estimates, caveats, an automatically requested critique and an optional meal-scoped follow-up chat. Analysis records and successful follow-up turns are stored in browser-local storage.

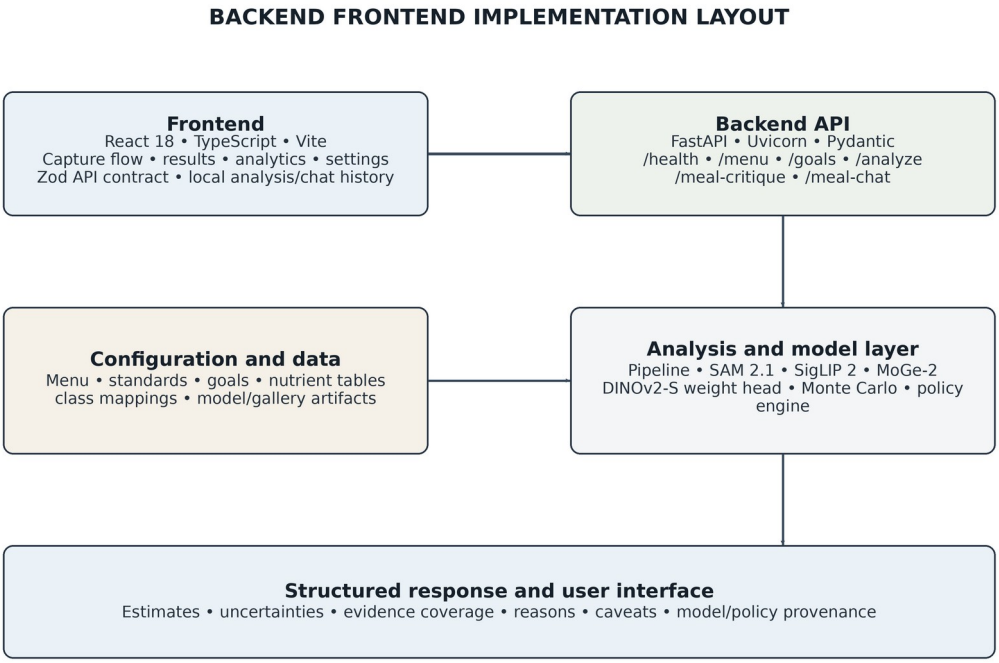


Figure 6.1: Backend and frontend implementation layout

Technology	Role in NutriSense	Repository evidence
Python 3.14 + uv	Backend runtime and inference orchestration.	pyproject.toml and backend source.
FastAPI + Uvicorn + AnyIO	REST API, multipart upload and bounded asynchronous service.	main.py routes and middleware.
PyTorch + Transformers	Deep-learning runtime and pretrained model loading.	Model adapters under models/ and engine/depth.py.

Technology	Role in NutriSense	Repository evidence
SAM 2.1 Hiera-Large	Food segmentation and vessel-mask candidates.	models/dish_segmenter.py.
SigLIP 2 Base	Gallery-based food embedding and classification.	models/food_classifier.py and gallery artifacts.
MoGe-2 ViT-L	Monocular geometry/depth estimation.	engine/depth.py.
DINOv2-S weight head	Learned mass regression for mapped no-card cases when checkpoint is present.	models/weight_head.py and data/weight_head.pt.
OpenCV + Pillow	Image decoding, ArUco detection and camera metadata.	main.py and models/scale_anchor.py.
NumPy + PyYAML	Numerical estimation, sampling and configuration loading.	engine modules and data/configuration files.
React 18 + TypeScript + Vite	Frontend analysis, result and settings interfaces.	frontend/package.json and frontend/src/.
Zod + Vitest	API response validation and frontend tests.	Generated contract and frontend test suite.
Pytest + Ruff + Pyright	Backend tests, linting and type-check gates.	pytest.ini, ruff.toml, pyright baseline and CI.

Table 6.1: Software and technology stack

6.2 Details of the Modules

6.2.1 API and Request Handling Module

The entry point main.py creates the FastAPI application, configures CORS, logging and the inference limiter, and exposes the API routes. The / endpoint provides a basic service message. /health provides a health state. /menu returns configured dishes, days, class bands, capture fields and policy settings. /goals returns general WHO daily-goal reference data by age band, sex and activity level; the source code documents that this read-only general-mode endpoint does not alter school-meal compliance. /analyze accepts the multipart form and invokes the inference pipeline in a bounded worker thread.

6.2.2 Configuration and Data Management Module

config.py centralises file paths and YAML/JSON/NPZ loading. It uses repository-relative paths rather than the process working directory, and caches parsed configuration objects. The

module includes loaders for menu, standards, nutrients, yields, general goals, ingredient densities, anchor configuration, gallery embeddings and WED dish mappings. Centralised loading avoids each subsystem maintaining a separate interpretation of menu or policy values.

6.2.3 Input Gates and Capture Lint Module

engine.gates defines a single gate table. The input gates evaluate digital zoom, supported menu day and class band. A separate scope gate is evaluated after the dish is classified. The capture lint checks technical conditions such as image resolution and marker adequacy. Gate rejection returns a failure and a reason through a common helper, ensuring that the failure record and displayed reason derive from the same source.

6.2.4 Scale Anchor and Camera Geometry Module

models.scale_anchor reads relevant EXIF values, detects the configured ArUco marker, validates its quiet zone and estimates centimetres per pixel from its known size. It also attempts to estimate marker pose and camera distance using a camera matrix. The anchor result includes a method label, scale interval, homography/pose information, tilt, distance and diagnostic extras. When marker detection fails, the module returns a prior anchor rather than a false metric measurement.

6.2.5 Segmentation and Classification Modules

models.dish_segmenter wraps SAM 2.1 loading and inference. A model registry provides lazy initialisation. The segmentation result contains a binary mask and diagnostic fields. The same module contains a multi-vessel item segmentation routine using grid prompts and IoU deduplication. models.food_classifier wraps SigLIP 2 and gallery lookup to map the food region to a dish identity. The classifier and gallery vocabulary are related to menu configuration and WED mappings.

6.2.6 Depth and Portion Estimation Modules

engine.depth wraps the MoGe-2 model and scale-calibration procedure. models.portion_estimator combines segmentation, depth/geometry, dish component definitions and density assumptions to estimate mass, volume and uncertainty. The engine chooses between the geometric route and the learned WED mass route according to anchor

tier and dish mapping. The response indicates which portion path generated the grams, such as card_geometry, ingredient_head, learned_head, prior_geometry or multi_item; null is used when no portion result was produced.

6.2.7 Nutrition Monte Carlo and Compliance Modules

engine.mc samples component nutrient values and aggregates item-level samples into a meal-level distribution. It stores nutrient composition provenance, including the source table hash, component grams, densities and point contributions where available. engine.compliance computes nutrient probabilities and evidence coverage, then selects PASS, FAIL or

BORDERLINE according to the standards configuration. Salt remains advisory; raw ingredient allocation figures are diagnostics, not verdict inputs.

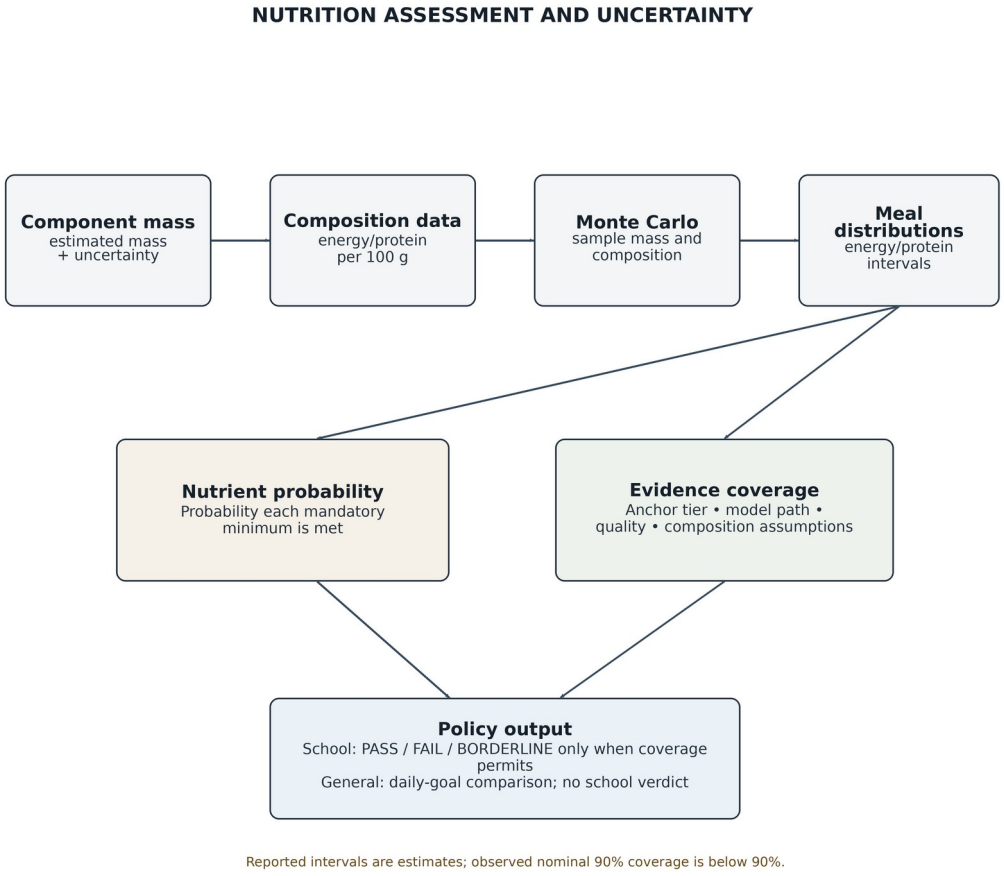


Figure 6.2: Nutrition assessment and uncertainty reporting

6.2.8 Analysis Contract and Frontend Module

engine.contract owns the structured response types and helper functions for stage failures,

gate rejections, policy loading and logging. The frontend consumes an API contract represented in TypeScript and Zod. The current response includes verdict, reasons, failures, lint, anchor, segmentation, classification, dish, portion, nutrition, coverage, assumptions, advisory, compliance, model_versions, policy, path_used, degradations and items. The generated contract keeps frontend validation aligned with the backend response.

6.3 Challenges Encountered and Strategies Used to Address Them

Challenge	**Effect on system**	**Mitigation / remaining limitation**
Food mask includes plate, rim or table	Area and depth may be overstated, producing a large mass error.	SAM candidate solidity/area/containment checks and box-prompt fallback; broader real-photo validation remains necessary.
Small/degenerated centre-point masks	A tiny mask may be a fragment, not a complete food region.	Reject below-threshold masks and retry with a box prompt.
Missing or poor-quality scale marker	No defensible physical image scale.	Measured/prior anchor tiers, capture guidance and explicit estimate disclaimer.
Monocular depth scale ambiguity	Depth may be inaccurate in metric units.	Calibrate with measured marker geometry; reduce coverage when calibration is unavailable.
GPU memory exhaustion	Inference can fail during model loading or execution.	Clear model registry/cache and retry once; report structured failure if retry fails.
Model loading cost	Large models increase startup time and VRAM pressure.	Lazy loading, process-level serialized inference and CUDA/CPU device selection.
Variable recipes and composition	Nutrient estimates may be biased even when mass is correct.	Expose assumptions and nutrient provenance; widen uncertainty for generic recipes.
Multi-vessel segmentation and assignment	Masks can spill or the same component can be assigned more than once.	Separate vessel masks and aggregate meal items; independent weighed validation remains open.
Uncalibrated intervals	Nominal 90% intervals may under-cover.	Do not claim calibrated confidence; the current candidate fails the registered width/coverage gate.

Challenge	**Effect on system**	**Mitigation / remaining limitation**
Runtime/testing environment variability	Restricted CPU/sandbox runs can stall.	Record verification status by environment; avoid unreplicated full-suite claims.

Table 6.2: Implementation challenges and mitigation strategies

CHAPTER 7

TESTING AND RESULTS

Testing is considered at three levels: unit testing of individual functions and modules, integration testing of the API and pipeline boundaries, and system-level evaluation of frontend/backend behaviour and model quality. The repository contains test suites and documented evaluation records. This report distinguishes collected test counts, passed test results, benchmark findings and model-quality metrics. A collected test count does not establish that the tests passed.

7.1 TESTING

7.1.1 Unit Testing

Unit tests verify individual functions and module contracts. The codebase includes tests for segmentation selection, marker/anchor behaviour, pipeline gates, portion estimation, Monte Carlo calculations, compliance logic, failure contracts, weight-head loading and evaluation metrics. Unit-level cases are used to verify both nominal behaviour and edge cases such as malformed images, absent marker evidence, unsupported inputs and failed model stages.

The model-readiness record reports focused test results for weight-head loading, evaluation metrics, grouped cross-validation split isolation, Nutrition5k nutrient evaluation and nutrition provenance. It also records a lock-guard validation of 502 checks with zero skipped and zero failed in the current verification attempt. These focused outcomes should be cited separately from the full backend suite.

7.1.2 Integration Testing

Integration testing checks whether the API routes, configuration loaders, model registry, inference pipeline, response contract and frontend expectations work together. The API has tests for malformed and oversized uploads and the per-process inference limiter. A happy-wire contract fixture check was recorded as passed. The frontend contains tests for wire parity, selectors, wizard interactions and policy-note rendering.

The saved readiness record reports that the frontend Vitest suite passed 70 tests across 11 files and that the production frontend build completed. A later backend verification collected 281 tests but did not complete in the restricted environment; this report does not claim that the latest full backend suite passed.

on 30 October 2026: 281 tests were collected (271 non-GPU and 10 GPU-marked), but the full current run did not complete in the restricted environment. An earlier local

verification record reports 281 passed, but the later run did not reproduce that result. The report therefore does not claim that the current full backend suite passed in the latest verification environment.

7.1.3 System Testing

System testing considers the complete path from a browser upload to a structured analysis response. The README documents the local backend on port 8731 and frontend on port 5173. The API includes GET /health, GET /menu, GET /goals and POST /analyze. The

/analyze route enforces a default 12 MiB upload cap, reads the image and EXIF data, executes inference through a one-slot limiter and removes the temporary upload in a finally block.

The readiness record includes API benchmarks from an RTX 4060 Laptop GPU development machine. Two sequential real-canteen-photo scored calls had a reported p50 of 8.263 seconds and p95 of 8.338 seconds, with all responses returning HTTP 200 and a FAIL verdict. The sample size of two calls is too small to establish a stable latency percentile. Separate eight-call tests produced p95 values of 735 ms and 751 ms, but all returned cannot_verify; these numbers represent fast abstention paths, not successful analysis. Sustained load, cold-start distributions, remote network behaviour and multi-worker concurrency remain unmeasured.

7.2 RESULTS

7.2.1 Portion-Mass Estimation Results on WED

The active DINOv2-S weight head has a WED DEV baseline of 15.034 g MAE across 108 views, 21 plates and 1,218 ROIs. The plate-bootstrap 95% confidence interval for mean MAE is 12.227–18.889 g. A one-time WED LOCKED report records 14.667 g MAE on 2,793 ROIs and 48 plates; the locked result is historical and must not be used for tuning. These are ROI-level mass-regression metrics, not whole-meal nutrient accuracy.

The active SigLIP 2 gallery classifier reaches 81.03% top-1 accuracy (987/1,218 crops) on the saved WED DEV crop report, with approximately 82.12% macro recall. In a forced single-label top-1 evaluation, micro precision, recall and F1 equal 81.03%. The DEV evidence is contaminated by gallery overlap (41 of 108 images), and the saved report lacks

per-crop predictions and a complete confusion matrix; macro precision and macro F1 cannot be recovered. The DINOv2-feature/SigLIP fusion reached 82.27% on the same crops but remains an unpromoted research candidate; its paired plate-bootstrap interval includes no improvement.

Five-fold grouped cross-validation over WED TRAIN plates is reported at 16.421 g pooled MAE across 11,759 ROIs and 198 held-out plates. The fold MAEs are 15.684, 15.720, 16.184, 16.521 and 18.096 g, with fold standard deviation 0.884 g. The repository describes this as a TRAIN-only grouped generalisation estimate and not as a comparison against the LOCKED test set.

7.2.2 Uncertainty Calibration

The nominal 90% prediction intervals are documented as under-covering. The readiness report states 85.22% coverage on the measured DEV carve and 82.77% on the one-time LOCKED evaluation. A global calibration multiplier required to reach 90% coverage increased interval width by 47%, exceeding the pre-registered 25% width cap. Per-class calibration also failed the recorded coverage and width gates. Therefore, the project must not present the present intervals as calibrated 90% confidence intervals.

7.2.3 Nutrition Estimation and Validation

The nutrition engine calculates energy and protein by multiplying estimated component grams with per-100 g composition values. The nutrient table identifies some rows as literature-derived and others as assumed. In particular, sambar, vegetable rice and Bisi Bele Bath rows are marked assumed. The menu configuration also uses assumed component shares and bulk densities for some dishes. These assumptions are carried into the analysis result rather than silently treated as measured truth.

The readiness record reports an exploratory Nutrition5k held-out evaluation over 47 dish-ID-held-out dishes. The unfiltered all-slot output has very high errors (3,208.595 g total-mass MAE, 2,916.463 kcal MAE and 126.724 g protein MAE among the documented outputs) and is not considered a usable meal prediction. An oracle-present-ingredient diagnostic gives lower errors, but it uses held-out ingredient labels and is explicitly non-deployable. Neither result supports a serving-quality nutrient accuracy claim. A validated food-presence/identity and portion model with compatible ground truth is still required.

7.2.4 Real-capture Pilot and Multi-item Findings

The 30 October 2026 real-capture pilot covered 23 angle views of six unchanged plates. Twenty views had measured anchors and three had prior anchors. The repository records unusually large measured multi-item mask-area sums relative to the top-level food mask (2.84 to 7.71 times on multi-item records). A 14-pair same-image comparison showed

different MAE behaviour between card and forced-prior paths; however, the repository warns that the small pilot does not establish generalisation and that the prior result may reflect error cancellation. These plates are permanently labelled evaluation-only and must not be reused for model tuning.

Model or component	**Measured metrics**	**Metric boundary and interpretation**
SigLIP 2 gallery classifier (active)	Top-1 accuracy: 81.03% (987/1,218). Micro precision, recall and F1: 81.03% each. Approximate macro recall: 82.12%.	38 classes / 21 plates; 41/108 DEV views overlap gallery sources. No full confusion matrix; macro precision/F1 unavailable. Crop score, not meal accuracy.
DINOv2-feature + SigLIP fusion (research candidate)	Top-1 accuracy: 82.27%. Paired gain: +1.23 pp (95% CI −1.73 to +4.39). F1: not reported.	Not deployed; CI includes zero. No complete confusion matrix for macro F1.
SAM 2.1 Hiera-Large segmentation	Real-mask accuracy, IoU, Dice, precision, recall and F1: not measured.	Synthetic checks cover software invariants only. The 23-view pilot is EVAL-ONLY.
MoGe-2 ViT-L depth	Depth accuracy/RMSE unavailable (no ground-truth depth maps). Historical unscaled mass diagnostic: MAE 1,524.3 g; MAPE 3,506%; plate MAE 4,618.7 g.	These are failed portion diagnostics, not depth errors or scores for card-calibrated serving.
DINOv2-S WED learned weight head (active no-card regression)	DEV: MAE 15.034 g; MAPE 18.30%; 90% interval coverage 85.22%; mean width 62.16 g; 95% MAE CI 12.227–18.889 g.	1,218 ROIs / 108 views / 21 plates. Regression: accuracy/F1 do not apply. DEV used for model selection.
DINOv2-S WED learned weight head (one-time locked record)	LOCKED: MAE 14.667 g; MAPE 19.99%; 90% interval coverage 82.77%; mean width 59.58 g; 95% MAE CI 13.331 –16.029 g.	2,793 ROIs / 248 views / 48 plates. Historical one-time result; not rerun or used for tuning.
ArUco marker detector (classical computer vision)	Historical measured-anchor coverage: 20/23 views (87.0%). Accuracy, precision, recall and F1: not measured.	Descriptive result on six EVAL-ONLY plates, not a general benchmark.
Ollama Cloud meal critique and follow-up	Smoke checks returned valid critique and follow-up responses. Accuracy, precision, recall and F1: not measured.	No reviewed prompt set or scoring rubric; quality is unmeasured.
Nutrient composition and policy rules	Meal-level nutrient/compliance accuracy, precision, recall and F1: not measured.	No independent meal-level energy/protein ground truth; assumptions remain in nutrient inputs.

Table 7.1: Project evaluation metrics and documented evidence

7.2.5 Overall Readiness Assessment

The project readiness record identifies a reproducible frozen baseline and dataset provenance

audits as met. The model-improvement criterion is not met because the tested candidate failed a pre-registered subgroup guardrail. Uncertainty calibration is not met for confidence claims. Production nutrition quality is not met because the Nutrition5k candidate is rejected and complete meal-level nutrition ground truth remains inadequate. Operational readiness

remains open because deployment hardware and numeric latency, memory, timeout, concurrency and error-rate budgets have not been agreed.

The correct conclusion from the results is that NutriSense has a substantial, modular research implementation and documented intermediate mass-estimation evidence, but additional field validation and model improvement are required before it should be relied on for school-meal serving decisions. The system is useful as a prototype for structured data collection, model experimentation and evidence-aware reporting.

CHAPTER 8

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

8.1 Gantt Chart

The schedule below maps the stated July–November 2026 project session to the major workstreams. Month blocks are an indicative sequencing of the documented project activities, not a day-level attendance or task log.

Workstream	July	August	September	October	November
Problem definition and literature review	■	■			
Data/policy research and capture protocol	■	■	■	■	■
System architecture and API design		■	■		
Model integration: segmentation, recognition, depth	■	■	■	■	■
Portion and nutrient estimation			■	■	
Frontend implementation	■	■	■	■	■
Integration, testing and evaluation				■	■
Documentation and final review	■	■	■	■	■

Table 8.1: Indicative project work plan / Gantt chart

8.2 Team Roles and Responsibilities in Project Execution

Team member	Assigned workstream	Detailed responsibilities
Aryan Kumar (1BM23AI037)	Literature, research and data collection	Review relevant food-recognition, portion-estimation and nutrition literature; support source verification, data-collection planning and documentation of evidence.
Roshanth V (1BM23AI155)	Literature, research and data collection	Support dataset and policy research; organize capture metadata and collection records; contribute to literature synthesis and research traceability.
S S Gokula Swamy (1BM23AI158)	Backend and frontend development	Contribute to API and pipeline integration, configuration/contract alignment, browser workflow implementation and structured result presentation.
Somanath S D (1BM23AI187)	Backend and frontend development	Contribute to model-service integration, frontend behavior, failure/uncertainty handling and end-to-end integration with the shared response contract.

Table 8.2: Team roles and responsibilities

The project records identify two shared workstreams: literature/research/data collection and backend/frontend development. The available record does not include an individual deliverable or review log; the responsibilities above therefore describe assigned scope rather than verified person-specific outputs.

8.3 Challenges Encountered and Mitigation Strategies

The project combines research experimentation, data collection, model integration and software engineering. The most significant coordination risks are dependencies between stages, shared configuration changes, large model downloads and GPU memory requirements, and the need to separate training/development data from evaluation-only data. These risks have been addressed through modular ownership, shared response contracts, configuration centralisation, model registry control, pinned dependencies and dataset provenance manifests.

Data evaluation discipline is especially important. The project uses a pilot/dev/holdout strategy for the golden set and a grouped split discipline for physical plates/views. The capture documentation states that holdout data should remain sealed until the final evaluation and must not be used for threshold or model tuning. The real-capture ArUco pilot is also marked evaluation-only. These rules reduce the risk of leakage and optimistic performance claims.

The remaining project-management tasks include expanding independent field captures, agreeing measurable production service-level objectives, reviewing the model readiness gates, validating the recipe composition table and obtaining the guide’s approval of the final report and research-paper submission plan.

CONCLUSION & FUTURE WORK

NutriSense demonstrates an integrated AI/ML workflow for estimating food portion mass and assessing selected nutritional adequacy indicators from meal images. The project combines image segmentation, visual embedding-based dish recognition, fiducial marker geometry, monocular depth estimation, learned mass regression, Monte Carlo uncertainty propagation and probability-based compliance rules. Its principal engineering contribution is the separation of model inference, evidence quality, nutrition calculation and policy assessment into inspectable stages with a structured result contract.

The implementation includes a React/TypeScript interface, FastAPI backend, centralised configuration system, model registry, data/policy endpoints, automated testing and evaluation documentation. The repository records WED mass-estimation results and a one-time locked evaluation. It also records important limitations: the current nominal 90% intervals under-cover, multi-item segmentation remains unstable on some real images, several nutrient rows and recipe parameters are assumed, nutrition model transfer has not passed its readiness gate, and production operational targets have not been established.

Therefore, the project should be regarded as a research prototype and decision-support system. It should not be used as the sole basis for nutrition programme compliance decisions until representative field validation, improved calibration and compatible nutrient ground truth are available. In its current state, NutriSense provides a useful platform for reproducible experiments and structured observations, while explicitly communicating when the image evidence is inadequate.

Future Work

The project can be further improved by expanding the real-world dataset to include hundreds of independently weighed food plates collected across multiple cooking sessions, camera angles, serving vessels, food textures and portion-size categories. Development and holdout datasets should be separated based on physical plates and cooking sessions to ensure reliable evaluation. Segmentation accuracy can be enhanced, particularly for bowls, reflective plates, mixed foods and multi-vessel trays, by collecting pixel-level annotations or validated masks for a representative real-world photo benchmark.

Dish recognition can be improved by developing a larger and more diverse food image

gallery and evaluating it using field-based data splits. Performance should be measured using precision, recall, confusion matrices and abstention coverage. Similarly, mass estimation should be strengthened using diverse training and validation datasets, class-specific error analysis and predefined evaluation criteria while preserving a separate locked evaluation set. Ingredient composition and food density values should also be validated against locally measured recipes and authoritative food-composition tables, replacing assumed values only when reliable evidence is available.

Furthermore, a complete meal-level nutrition estimation model should be developed and validated using compatible ground-truth energy and protein measurements before reporting calorie or protein estimation errors. Uncertainty intervals should be recalibrated using group-separated datasets to ensure reliable coverage and appropriate interval widths. For deployment, suitable hardware, memory requirements, response latency, timeout limits, error rates and concurrent request targets must be established and tested under different workloads.

Finally, security measures such as authentication, HTTPS/TLS, secure data storage, retention policies and access logging should be implemented before deployment beyond a trusted local environment. Usability testing should also be conducted with intended field users, and a proper human-review process should be established to ensure that automated nutrition estimates remain advisory, transparent and auditable.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

The project provided practical learning in the design and implementation of an end-to-end AI/ML system. The main outcomes are summarised below.

- Understanding the distinction between an image-classification demo and a multi-stage computer-vision system in which segmentation, identity, geometry, mass and nutrition estimation affect one another.
- Practical exposure to pretrained vision models, including SAM 2.1 segmentation, SigLIP 2 visual embeddings, MoGe-2 monocular geometry and DINOv2-based feature extraction for mass regression.
- Understanding camera calibration, EXIF metadata, ArUco fiducial markers, homography, camera pose and the limitations of physical scale recovery from a single image.
- Experience in designing data capture protocols with controlled camera settings, marker placement, weighing procedures, metadata recording, quality assurance and leakage prevention.
- Understanding probabilistic estimation and uncertainty propagation through Monte Carlo sampling, including the difference between nominal interval level and empirical interval coverage.
- Learning to encode policy rules as configurable, testable logic rather than embedding thresholds throughout model code.
- Backend engineering experience using FastAPI, asynchronous request handling, upload-size limits, inference concurrency controls, temporary-file cleanup, structured logging and typed API contracts.
- Frontend engineering experience with React, TypeScript, Vite, Zod validation and component-level automated testing.
- Learning model evaluation discipline through grouped data splits, bootstrap intervals, holdout restrictions, subgroup guardrails and explicit rejection of candidates that fail pre-registered criteria.
- Appreciation of responsible AI requirements, including privacy-preserving image capture, transparent assumptions, source attribution, abstention and human oversight.
- Improved project collaboration through role allocation across research/data collection and backend/frontend development, with integration dependencies managed through shared contracts and configuration.

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Project repository: https://github.com/Lion4467cat/NutriSense

APPENDIX A: APPLICATION SCREENSHOTS

The following figures show the current light-theme NutriSense interface across its main workflows.

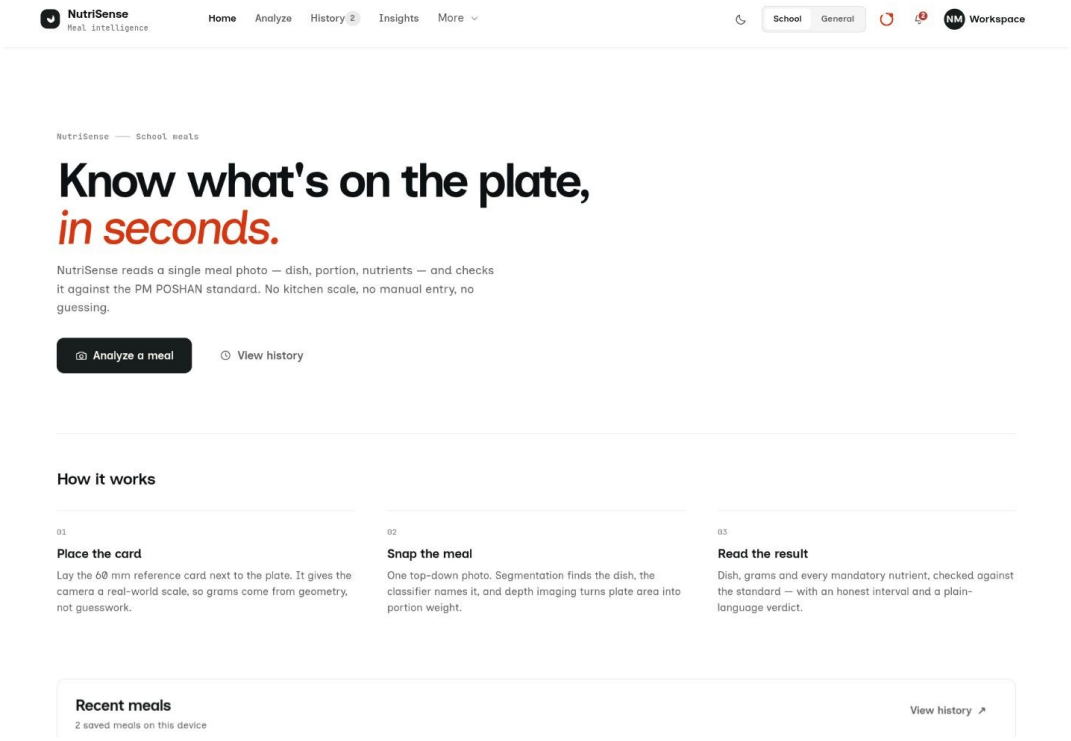


Figure A.1: NutriSense dashboard

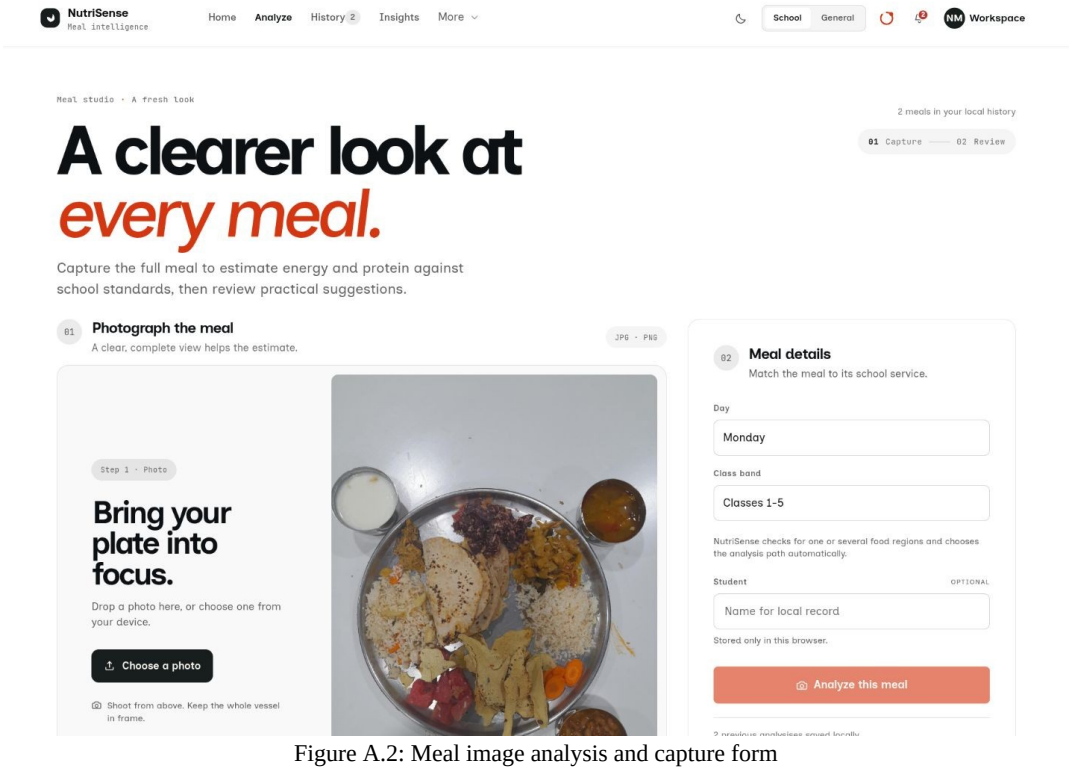


Figure A.2: Meal image analysis and capture form

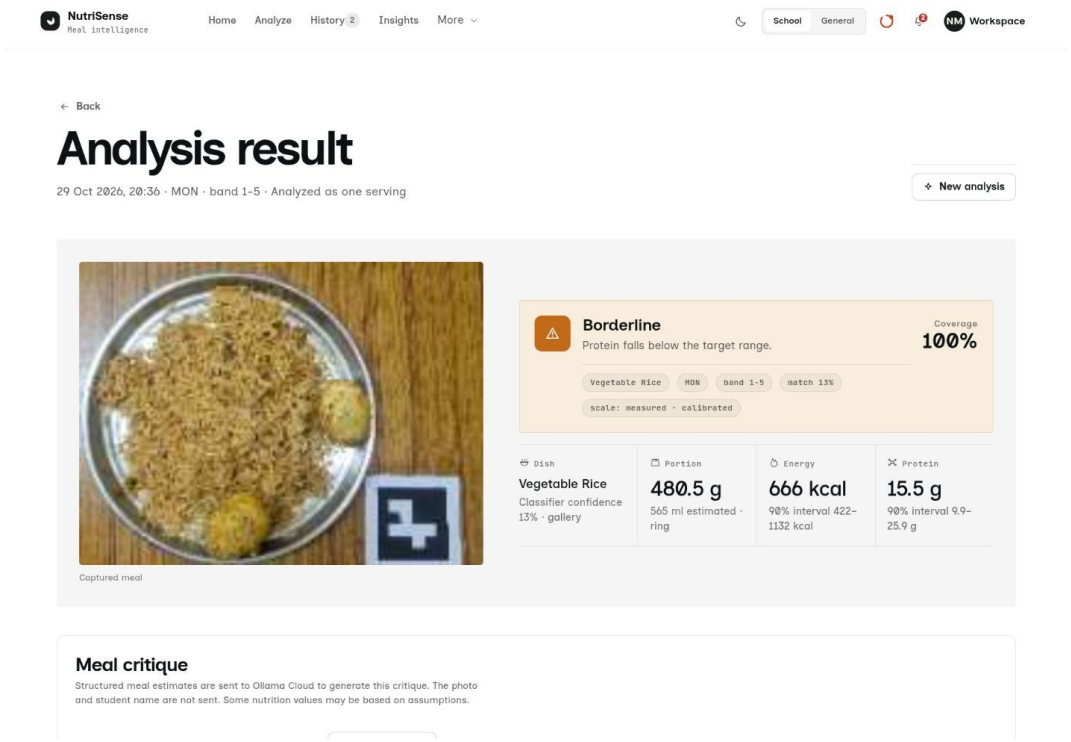


Figure A.3: Analysis result overview

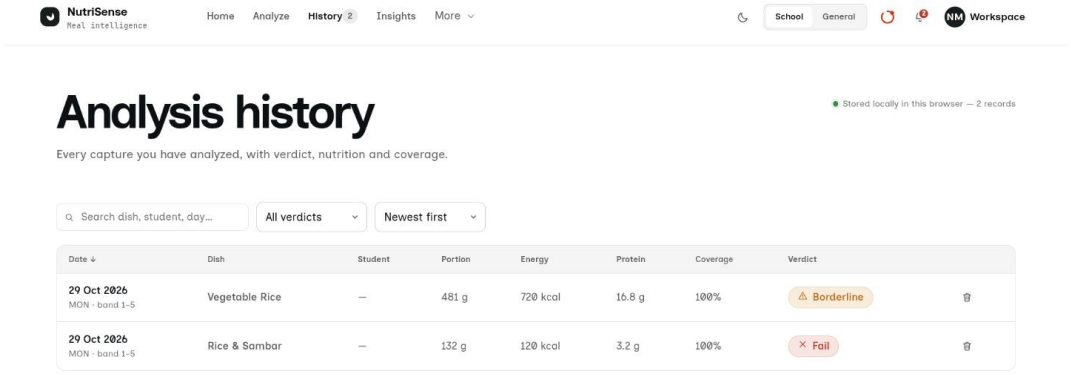


Figure A.4: Analysis history

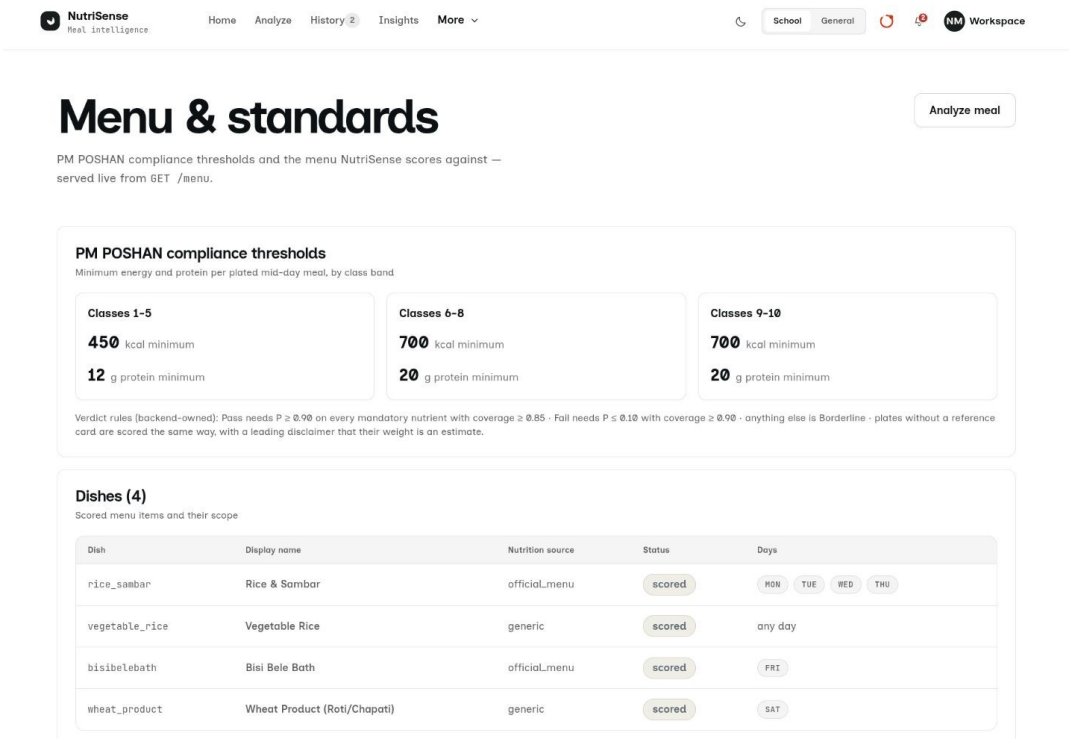


Figure A.5: Menu and nutrition standards

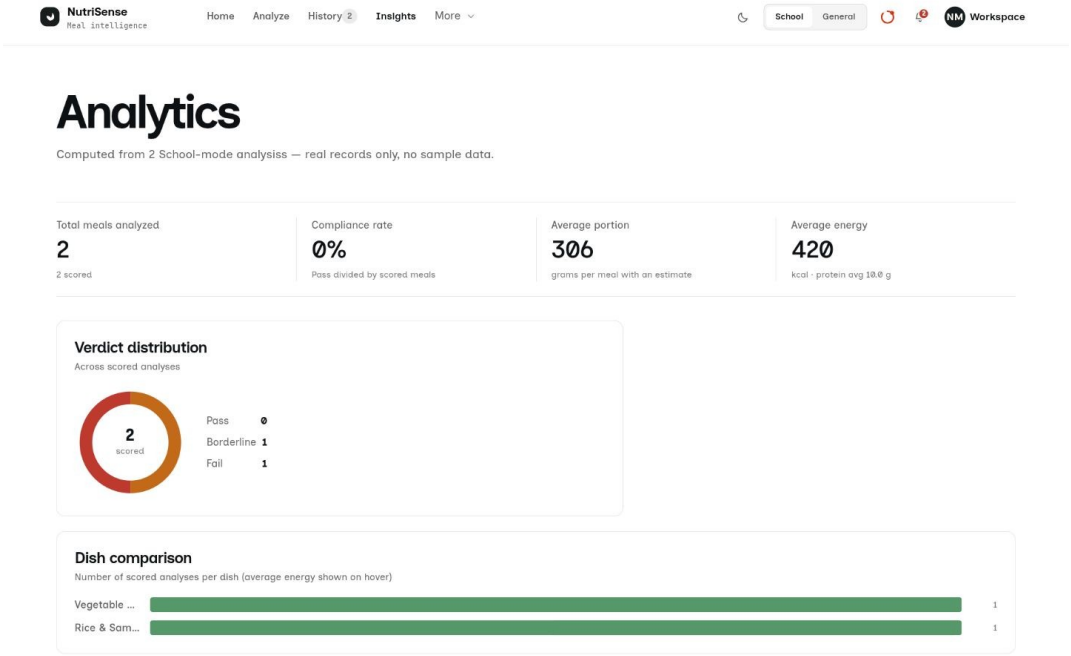


Figure A.6: Analytics dashboard

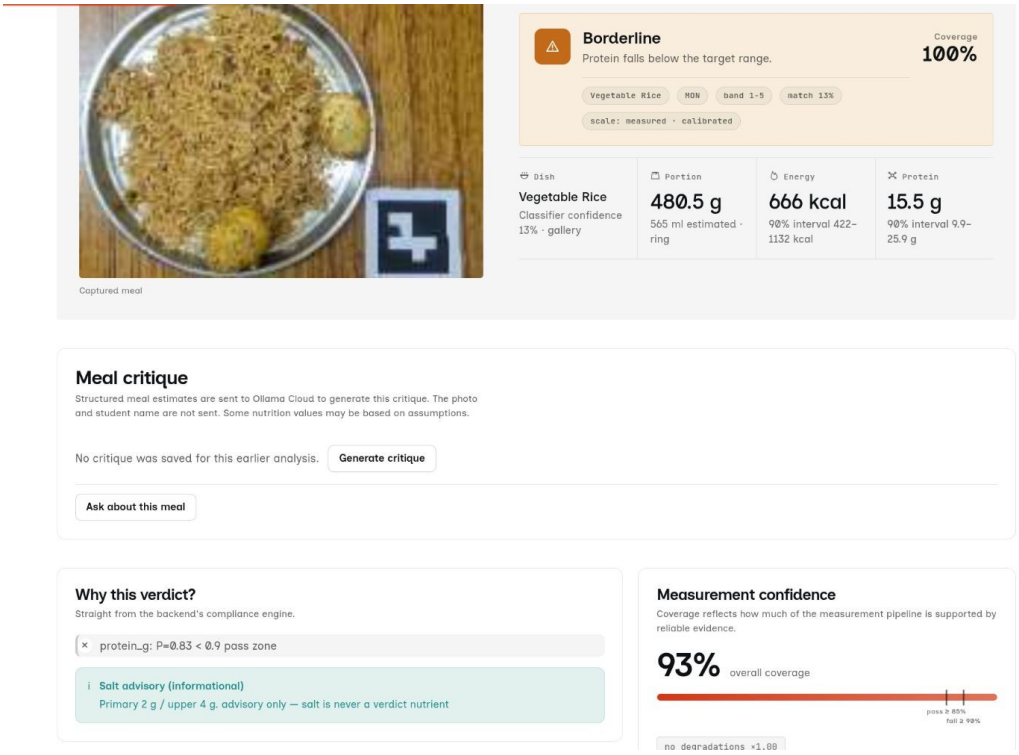


Figure A.7: Meal critique and conversation entry

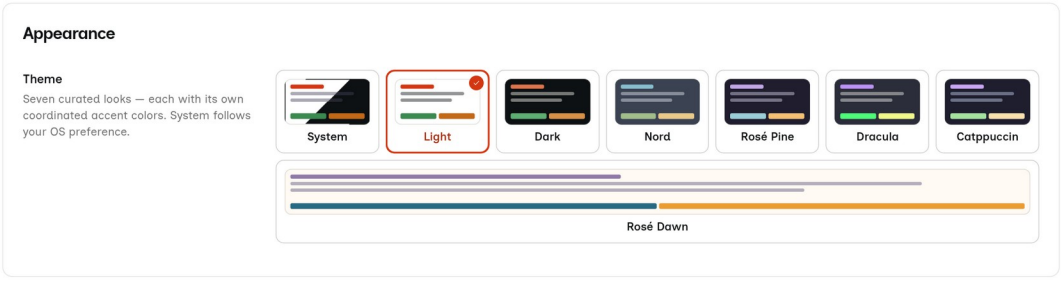


Figure A.8: Settings appearance and theme choices